

Forty SEO Ideas

What a review of the live site found on 4 September 2026, and forty things that would help more readers find the library — ordered by impact within each group.

Method: curl probes of about sixty live URLs and every sitemap child; Lighthouse 12 (mobile) on the home page, `/books/` and a chapter; the head markup of each page type; and the English content fixtures for counts. Google’s PageSpeed API was quota-blocked, so the vitals below are lab numbers.

WHERE THE SITE STANDS

What is already strong

- ✓ Every public route is **prerendered** with a self-referential canonical, per-locale `hreflang` with `x-default`, Open Graph tags and JSON-LD (Book, Chapter, Person, Quotation, BreadcrumbList, ItemList).
- ✓ The sitemap is an **index over per-type and per-locale children**, so Search Console can answer “is Swahili indexing?”; robots.txt buries the old WordPress URLs; www and http redirect cleanly.
- ✓ Time to first byte is **30 ms** behind Cloudflare with Brotli; localized titles are written for the query (“Humildad de Andrew Murray — lectura gratuita en línea”).
- ✓ Author bios are genuinely translated (the Ukrainian and Hindi author pages are 2,000+ words in-script), so the all-locale author `hreflang` is honest.

MEASUREMENTS THAT DRIVE THE LIST

SIGNAL	VALUE
No-slash detail URL (<code>/books/humility-2</code>)	200, 5,764 B shell
Unknown path (<code>/nonexistent-page</code>)	200, same shell
Chapter URLs in sitemaps with <code>lastmod</code>	0 of 1,878
Non-English works that are <code>ai_unreviewed</code>	220 of 220
Book descriptions over 300 characters	86 of 100
English books with a publication year	6 of 100
Chapter titles with mid-title “Of”, “The”...	237
Chapter page links to the author page	0
<code>/books/</code> HTML size (inline SVG covers)	570 KB (337 KB)
Mobile LCP: home / books / chapter	6.2 / 5.6 / 4.3 s
Lighthouse SEO: home / books / chapter	92 / 92 / 83

HOW TO READ THE LIST

Each idea carries a build-cost tag: **SMALL** an afternoon, **A PR** one focused pull request, **PROJECT** several PRs or ongoing editorial work. Within each group the first items matter most.

IF YOU DO FIVE THINGS FIRST

- 1 Redirect the no-slash detail URLs and return real 404s (ideas 1-2) — the shell is indexed as a duplicate of every book, chapter and author today.
- 2 Turn scripture references into real links (idea 21) — the largest internal-linking win available, for 1,184 pages that currently have one inbound link each.
- 3 Author in chapter titles and short meta descriptions (ideas 12, 14).
- 4 Fix mobile LCP on text pages (idea 34).
- 5 Decide the policy for unreviewed AI editions (idea 8) before the locale count grows again.

Groups: crawl and indexing (1-11) · titles, snippets and structured data (12-20) · internal linking and content (21-33) · performance and Core Web Vitals (34-40).

GROUP ONE

Crawl and indexing hygiene

The site's biggest leaks are not missing tags but URLs that answer when they should not, and dates that say nothing. Every item here is deterministic and testable from a shell.

1 Redirect no-slash detail URLs to the slash form SMALL

`/books/humility-2`, `/books/humility-2/1` and `/authors/andrew-murray` all return 200 with the empty SPA shell: no title, no body, a duplicate of every real page. A 301 at the host or Cloudflare layer gives each page one indexable address.

Seen: curl of the three URLs; 5,764-byte response, identical for every slug.

2 Return a real 404 SMALL

Unknown paths also serve the shell with 200, so Google files them as soft 404s and keeps recrawling. Ship a `404.html` with a 404 status; as a safety net give the fallback shell a title and `<meta name="robots" content="noindex">`.

Seen: `/nonexistent-page` and `/books/nonexistent-book/` both 200.

3 Fix the robots.txt error SMALL

`Feed:` is not a directive; Lighthouse marks the file invalid on every page. Move the line into a comment and keep `Sitemap:`.

Seen: Lighthouse robots-txt audit, "Unknown directive".

4 noindex the client-only pages SMALL

`/search` is neither disallowed nor noindexed, and disallowed pages (`/login`, `/settings`, `/notebook`) can still be indexed from links. A robots meta on each closes the gap.

Seen: `/search/` has a title and no robots meta.

5 One trailing-slash policy for list pages SMALL

`/books` and `/books/` both serve identical HTML and the canonical says `/books`, while detail pages canonicalize to the slash form. Redirect one form to the other so equity does not split.

Seen: Both return 570,048 bytes; canonical differs from the detail convention.

6 Add lastmod to the chapter, author, scripture and quote sitemaps A PR

Only books and sermons carry it. Chapter text is re-baked often (the rebuild markers in the route files record why), so real dates let Google recrawl what changed instead of sampling nearly two thousand URLs blindly.

Seen: 0 of 1,878 English chapter URLs have `lastmod`; 198 of 198 book URLs do.

7 Real dates in feed.xml SMALL

Every entry's `published` and `updated` is the build timestamp, so each deploy announces the whole library as new. Use the row's creation date.

Seen: All entries stamped 2026-09-04T12:53, the last build.

8 Decide how to handle unreviewed AI editions PROJECT

Every non-English work is `ai_unreviewed`, and all are advertised through hreflang and sitemaps. Google's scaled-content policy makes that a risk. Either prioritize native review for Spanish and Portuguese, or gate a locale's sitemap on a reviewed share.

Seen: 220 of 220 translated books and sermons; about 1,900 localized chapter URLs.

9 Register with Bing Webmaster Tools and IndexNow SMALL

Cloudflare can push IndexNow pings on deploy. Bing and Yandex share is higher for the Ukrainian and Hindi audiences than for English.

Seen: no IndexNow key or Bing verification present.

10 A post-deploy SEO gate A PR

The prerender race that bakes the empty shell has struck at least six times per the rebuild markers. A deploy step that fetches a sample of sitemap URLs and fails if any is the 5,764-byte shell catches it before Google does.

Seen: six "Rebuild marker" comments in `books/[slug]/+page.ts`.

11 Search Console coverage in the admin A PR

The sitemap was split per locale for exactly this question. Pulling per-sitemap indexed-versus-submitted counts through the Search Console API into the existing coverage tab makes it a weekly glance.

GROUP TWO

Titles, snippets and structured data

The head markup is complete but not yet written for the searcher: chapter titles omit the author, descriptions are book blurbs, and the structured data leaves out the dates and language that make a Book entity whole.

12 Put the author in chapter titles SMALL

Today: “The Glory Of The Creature — Humility — Ochorus”. People search “andrew murray humility chapter 1”, so “... — Humility by Andrew Murray” earns the query for 1,878 pages at once.

Seen: chapter `<title>` on the live page.

13 Fix title-casing glitches in chapter titles A PR

Small words are capitalized mid-title: “Importance Of Prayer”, “The Love Of Jesus—what It Is”. They show in SERPs, breadcrumbs and JSON-LD.

Seen: 237 English chapter titles match the pattern.

14 Dedicated meta descriptions for books A PR

Most English descriptions run past 300 characters and end in a “Contents:” list, so Google truncates them mid-sentence. Add a short summary field, or cut at the first sentence boundary under 155 characters.

Seen: 86 of 100 over 300 characters; none under 160.

15 A site-wide default og:image SMALL

The home page and every chapter page have none, so shares of the site’s most-linked pages render as bare text cards. A branded fallback in `Seo.svelte` covers every route that has nothing better.

Seen: no `og:image` on `/` or on chapter pages.

16 Proper 1200×630 social cards for books and authors A PR

Book pages use the 443×668 cover JPEG and authors use the portrait, both the wrong shape. Sermons already have `/og/sermons/<slug>.png` twins; generate the same for books and authors.

Seen: `/covers/humility-2.jpg` is 443×668.

17 Enrich the Book JSON-LD A PR

Add `datePublished`, `inLanguage`, `isAccessibleForFree`, a `hasPart` chapter list and `workTranslation` links between editions. The year has to be backfilled first.

Seen: 6 of 100 English books carry a `publication_year`.

18 Enrich the Chapter JSON-LD SMALL

Add `wordCount`, `datePublished`, the author at chapter level and `publisher`, so the book-to-chapter graph is explicit rather than inferred.

Seen: Chapter carries name, position, `isPartOf`, `inLanguage` only.

19 Organization and editorial-policy signals A PR

Expand the Organization JSON-LD with founders, the Victoria and Kampala addresses and social `sameAs`; add a footer-linked page on how texts are sourced and how translations are reviewed. This is the trust story for a site that republishes public-domain text.

Seen: About page names both cities; no policy page exists.

20 Transliterated author names per locale A PR

Hindi and Arabic titles mix scripts (“Andrew Murray द्वारा”), but Hindi searchers type the name in Devanagari. A per-language author name field fixes titles, headings and Person markup together.

Seen: `/hi/books/humility-2/` title.

GROUP THREE

Internal linking and content

Chapters are 81% of the site's URLs and each one is a dead end: it links to its book and the next chapter, nothing else. Fixing the link graph is worth more than any new page type.

21 Make scripture references real links A PR

Chapter bodies wrap verses in `<a class="scripture-ref">` with no href, which Lighthouse flags as uncrawable. Pointing them at `/scripture/<book>/<chapter>/` gives the scripture pages thousands of contextual inbound links; keep the popover on click.

Seen: Lighthouse *crawlable-anchors*; 1,184 scripture URLs reachable only from the hub.

22 Author and related-work links on chapter pages A PR

A short "About the author" block with a link to the bio, plus "More by" and topic chips, densifies the graph for the largest page type.

Seen: 0 links to `/authors/` or other books on the sampled chapter.

23 Deepen book pages A PR

The main content is about 450 words. Add an author-bio excerpt, a first-chapter teaser, the publication year and a "Readers also read" shelf by topic.

Seen: 454 words inside `<main>` on `/books/humility-2/`.

24 Chapter-by-chapter summaries on book pages PROJECT

"<book> summary" is a large query class that the description's "Contents:" list half-serves. A structured synopsis section targets it properly.

25 Ship the per-quote indexable URLs plan PROJECT

The plan in `docs/perquote-seo.html` is written; each sourced quotation is a query in its own right and the pages anchor the quote-card and share features.

Seen: 12 authors have quote pages today.

26 Grow quote pages toward fifty per author PROJECT

"<author> quotes" is among the highest-volume patterns for these names; the quote-extraction playbook already encodes the method.

27 Scale the Articles section PROJECT

Five articles exist and they are the only pages answering question-shaped queries. Two a month, each funnelling into books and sermons, compounds.

Seen: 5 URLs under `/articles/` in the pages sitemap.

28 Expand topics from ten to thirty or forty PROJECT

Faith, holiness, revival, suffering, assurance and the like each deserve a hub with a 300-word editorial introduction, not only a shelf.

Seen: 10 topics in the ItemList on `/topics/`.

29 More hub facets for biographies A PR

Era landings exist; add country, tradition and century hubs (African authors first, per the African-voices push) as crawlable entry points to the 89 author pages.

30 Prev and next on scripture pages A PR

`/scripture/john/3/` is unique content but reachable only from the hub. Chapter-to-chapter links and a short introduction on high-demand chapters (Psalm 23, John 3, Romans 8) would help.

31 Section headings inside chapters A PR

The sampled chapter has no H2 in its body; only the footer has them. The import already added headings to 175 chapters, so extending that pass helps both readers and passage ranking.

32 Free PDF and EPUB downloads A PR

Book rows carry a `pdf_url`; "<title> pdf" is a strong intent. Offer the download on the book page with a canonical header pointing back at the HTML edition.

33 Link-earning outreach for the unique assets PROJECT

The scripture index ("which classics treat John 3") and the sourced quotes have no equivalent elsewhere. Pitch them to Bible-study bloggers, seminary libraries and the external-links sections of author Wikipedia articles.

GROUP FOUR

Performance and Core Web Vitals

The server answers in 30 ms and the page still takes four to six seconds to paint its largest text on a phone. The wait is fonts, a stack of render-blocking stylesheets and oversized images.

- 34

Cut LCP on text pages

A PR

The LCP element is a paragraph, so the delay is web fonts plus six or more render-blocking CSS files. Inline the critical CSS, merge the per-component stylesheets, and confirm `font-display: swap` or `optional`.

Seen: LCP 6.2 s home, 4.3 s chapter; FCP 3.1–3.5 s with 30 ms TTFB.
- 35

Shrink the /books page

A PR

The HTML carries 86 inline cover SVGs and 2,232 DOM nodes. Serve generated covers as `<img>` files (some already are) and paginate or lazy-render the shelf.

Seen: 570 KB HTML, 337 KB of it SVG; Lighthouse *dom-size* at 0.5.
- 36

Responsive portraits

A PR

Home serves 45–75 KB JPEGs for 44-pixel avatars. Generate thumbnail sizes with `srcset`, as the cover pipeline already does for WebP.

Seen: Lighthouse *uses-responsive-images*: 434 KB wasted on `/`.
- 37

Longer browser cache on images

SMALL

Covers and portraits ship `max-age=0`, so every repeat visit revalidates each image. A day or more is safe for files that only change with a deploy.

Seen: `cache-control: public, max-age=0, s-maxage=300` on `/covers/`.
- 38

Preconnect to api.ochorus.com

SMALL

Add the preconnect and make sure the client-side personal blocks never delay first paint on prerendered pages.

Seen: Lighthouse *uses-rel-preconnect*: about 180 ms.
- 39

Trim JavaScript on chapter pages

A PR

Two chunks waste about 120 KB per page. Splitting the reader’s text-to-speech, marks and offline features out of the shared bundle lowers the cost of the largest page type.

Seen: *unused-javascript*: 119 KB on the chapter, 236 KB on home.
- 40

Investigate the same-URL redirect Lighthouse reports

A PR

On `/` and `/books/` Lighthouse charges six to seven seconds to a navigation to the same URL. It looks like a service-worker or hydration re-navigation; if real users hit it, it is the single largest vitals fix available.

Seen: *redirects* audit: 7,240 ms on `/`, 6,190 ms on `/books/`.

SEQUENCE

A sensible order

WAVE	IDEAS	WHY THIS ORDER
1 · Stop the leaks	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 7, 15, 37, 38	All small; each removes a defect Google can see today.
2 · Write for the query	12, 13, 14, 17, 18	Title, snippet and entity changes across every page in one prerender.
3 · Wire the graph	21, 22, 6, 10, 30	Internal links plus dated sitemaps and a deploy gate that keeps them honest.
4 · Paint faster	34, 35, 36, 39, 40	Vitals work; measure with Lighthouse before and after each PR.
5 · Grow	8, 23–29, 31–33, 9, 11, 16, 19, 20	Editorial and policy work that compounds once the plumbing is sound.